

OLOS — State & Trajectory

Executive summary for review

2026-08-09

This is my reconstructed understanding after being away since mid-June, drawn from a read-only audit of the repository and GitHub through 2026-08-09 (full evidence on branch `claudio/olos-reentry-audit-8bglhk`, directory `olos-recon/2026-07-24/`). Please flag anything that contradicts what you know — especially in §6.

1. What we are building

Three nested identities, each stated in our own docs. **Near term:** “the build-cycle operating system” — field observations → problem statements → votes → pods → projects → weekly Learning Logs → showcase, replacing forms and spreadsheets [README]. **Mid term:** “The Labs runs like open source” — Sectors as durable problem-domain communities, Cycles as incubator cohorts, Local Labs as the place-based tenancy spine, the org running its own machinery via org cycles/workstreams [SECTOR_MODEL, LOCAL_LABS, ORG_CYCLES]. **Long term: Project Ortelius** — “the legitimate, participatory, consented, open civic counterpart to Foundry”: a provenance-complete, consent-governed corpus of community sensemaking, with declared lead buyers of a frontier AI lab plus civic leaders (owner decision 2026-07-05) [ORTELIUS_NORTHSTAR]. Intended outcome, layered: members shipping civic projects in teams → a compounding sector commons → a clean, consented sensemaking corpus.

2. Where the system stands

Everything is **live in production alpha with real participant data**; dev and main are fully merged (promotion is near-daily). The chain is at **100 migrations**; roughly two-thirds of it and 74 of 118 API routes postdate mid-June. **Built:** the full cycle engine (verified end-to-end), Learning/Leadership Logs (replaced Pulse in July), the social layer, labs/sectors/org-cycle structure, public CMS with two-way Luma event sync, owner console, view-as debugging lens, member task system. **One slice deep:** sensemaking — field-survey intake, results, and citable per-observation anchors exist; the entire Ortelius graph spine (extracts, swipes, canvas, embeddings, `asset_links`) has **zero migrations**. The Frame-Creation canvas (“Triangulator”) lives in a second repo (`TheUpskillingLabs/triangles`); the current cohort does sensemaking *there*, in per-team GitHub working folders that deep-link back to OLOS survey rows (PR #302). An in-app port plan exists but has sat unmerged since 07-06 (PR #185). Which path wins is our biggest open architecture fork.

3. How the team operates

Development is agent-driven: roughly half of all commits are Claude-authored, steered through Claude Code sessions and the GitHub App; five agent roles are checked into `.claude/agents/`; the product itself deliberately runs almost no AI (one Haiku call for pod/project names; everything else is copy-prompt/BYO-LLM behind the Ortelius consent gate). Process reality: **zero formal reviews exist across all ~360 PRs**, ~97–100% self-merge, no branch protection, and CODEOWNERS still routes every review request to me (absent since June). Since 07-30 the stream collapsed to a **single operator** — every PR from #318 to #359 was authored *and* merged by MJ, with HQ assisting on branches; Brendan’s last merges are 07-25, amguzzi’s 07-27. **All activity stops 2026-08-04** with the tree clean. I do not know from the repo whether this is a planned pause or reallocation.

4. Direction of the last three weeks

The center of gravity moved from building structure to **operating the live Civics & Elections cohort**: an events rework around Luma (anchor events, member-only visibility tiers, synced About text; the bespoke hackathon page retired — “Luma owns the copy,” #337); a consolidated member task system (#342); the view-as simulation for debugging member issues (#344, security invariants verified); poderator tooling (#350–#359); and — notably — a **rewrite of the enrollment/revocation machinery I built** (#348: new `registered` enrollment status; the revocation cron becomes the sole writer of `inactive`; migration 00100 drops my 00030 idempotency index under “owner decision O2,” which I intend to ratify or contest). The sensemaking thread paused when Brendan did.

5. Top risks as I see them

- **Enforcement is dark:** the revocation cron has never been scheduled (removed “temporarily” 05-31; open p1 #213) — and after #348 it is now the *only* writer of `inactive`.

- **Ledger drift recurred:** migration 00099 was applied to the dev DB out-of-band under its old number (00092); prod's application state for 00092–00100 is unrecorded. Same species of drift that forced the 07-11 prod reset-and-rebuild (which itself is documented only on an unmerged branch).
- **Review vacuum has a measured cost:** stale unreviewed PRs required re-lands with renumbered migrations (#311/#312/#313 → #342/#344/#348); the original #313 carried a defect that would have mass-revoked the live cohort; merges now race CI (#354: 8 seconds open-to-merge).
- **Decisions live in PR bodies:** ~18 decision-carrying statements shipped unratified in merged PRs this window; the issue tracker recorded one issue in twelve days.
- **Known security follow-ups unfiled:** blind-voting authorship leak (flagged in #117's closure), erasure RPC FK gap, cron auth failing open when CRON_SECRET is unset, two prod-only fixes never codified as migrations.

6. What I need you to confirm or correct

1. Is the 08-04 stop a planned pause? Where are Brendan and amguzzi focused now — **triangles**, or elsewhere?
2. Prod state: has prod received migrations 00092–00100, and was dev's ledger reconciled after the 00099-as-00092 out-of-band apply? Who holds the Supabase/Vercel dashboards?
3. Decision O2 (dropping the revocation idempotency index) and the pending-observations visibility default (#302): do these stand as deliberate calls?
4. The sensemaking fork: is the GitHub working-folder bridge the model for this cohort only, with the in-app port (#185) still intended — and what would trigger the switch?
5. Is the revocation cron off by policy or by drift, and what cadence/labs semantics do we want when it goes live (#213)?

Companion document: *OLOS P1 & Hotfix-Debt Strategy* (same audit branch) — per-item evidence, reasoning, and a sequenced remediation plan.